

Loxone Task

Concepts

- My initial idea was to have some QR code that would link to an online guide which is short and to the point, utilizing video, short instructions, and screen shots to get users up and running with minimal unnecessary explanation (when I opened the box I saw that there already is a QR code with link to the guide)
- Deeper explanation can be given later for each individual area with other web content or downloadable PDFs
- Split the content up into logical chunks/modules
- This is meant to be a small scale sampling of the skills I can bring to the table including:
 - Needs assessment and defining goals and learning objectives
 - Determining the best method for delivering material
 - Content planning and creation (core data)
 - Creating mixed media including HTML, screen capture (picture/video), video editing, voice-over

Reasoning

- Giving customers a quick and easy win early on builds confidence
- During our discussion it was made clear that the current training is too confusing, so the barrier of entry/friction level is too high, therefore my goal is to simplify it
- Video is often faster than reading text and is preferred by most people these days (we live in a YT/Instagram shorts world)
- I wanted the guide to be more interactive as gamification is a popular way to teach
- I tried to make the design a bit more colorful with larger text to make users feel like they are having more fun, rather than being flooded with a bunch of overly complex technical documentation
- Creating smaller modules that cover specific topics is easier to digest than one long guide (modularity)

Limitations

- Due to the lack time to develop a full learning center, I chose to make an interactive html that borrows Loxone's design elements and some bootstrap elements
- I didn't want to just copy the existing videos (which are good if not a little long) so I tried something different - a YouTuber unboxing style video
- I borrowed existing Loxone video intro/outro and audio elements instead of creating my own both to be consistent and save time
- If this were the actual guide I would include some information about what could go wrong during setup and testing and how to troubleshoot/fix the issues
- My goal was not to create a guide which I would actually use in production, but to showcase some of my skills and style

- Even though I know how to use video recording gear, I do not have a professional video setup at home
- I wanted to utilize many other image, video, and GIF elements but was not able to manage it due to the time constraints

What I've Learned

Through this process I have learned:

- The basics of the Loxone Miniserver Gen 2, it's connectivity (digital ins/outs, analogue inputs, Tree extensions, Loxone switches/contacts/sensors)
- More functionality of the Loxone APP
- How to install and use the Loxone Config - understanding the basics of connecting to a Miniserver, updating the firmware, loading/saving/editing configurations, using devices and function blocks and adjusting their settings, visualizing the physical changes to the Miniserver in the Live View of the Loxone Config

Time Taken

- 19.6 - 1 hour creating html template with Loxone design and bootstrap elements
- 22.6 - 1 hour reading materials and creating lesson plan
- 26.6 - 4 hours developing content
- 30.6 - 4 hours unboxing sample case, fixing, updating, installing, tinkering/testing
- 1.7 - 8 hours developing content, taking screen shots and video capture, recording audio and editing audio and video, dealing with internet issues
- **Total time taken: Approximately 14 hours***

*I think the time would have been shorter if I had longer stretches of uninterrupted time. Plus I was using evenings and any free time I had, which generally meant I was tired from a long day or too hot from the heat wave ;)

Lesson Plan

Target Audience

Partners or users who are new to Loxone and who may not know much about automation but are probably somewhat familiar with the basics of electronics and building wiring/installations. A basic understanding of home electrical installation and appliances, as well as basic computer skills, is required. Students are not expected to know a lot about automation.

Page/Part/Task 1 - Power on and test

The first page/part/task will be a very quick intro and immediately getting started into the steps (with pictures, screen shots, video). The goal of this part is to:

- Plug in and turn on the sample box.
- Make sure it is working properly.
- Have 2-4 "exercises" which involve testing the included onboard technology (i.e. turn on the light, adjust the led speed, use the motion sensor, etc.)
- After each exercise there can be a brief explanation (or expandable section or link to longer explanation of the process behind what is happening).
- If necessary include explanation and screen shots of software (I think this will be in the next part).

Page/Part/Task 2 - Control using the Loxone app

The goal of this part is to:

- Connect to the built-in wifi and install the app on devices.
- Can use existing wifi screen shot.
- Use mobile app and browser control to explain basics with screen shots.
- 1-2 exercises using the app to control the sample box and accomplish simple tasks.

Page/Part/Task 3 - Customize with Loxone Config

The goal of this part is to:

- Download, install and use the Loxone Config software.
- Search and connect to the miniserver.
- Load, modify, and save a program to the miniserver.
- Create own program from scratch? Don't worry about breaking anything, you can always download the default configuration and reapply it to the miniserver.
- Exercises can be any of the above items.

Page/Part/Task 4

The goal of this final part is to:

- Wrap up what you learned.
- Deal with FAQ.
- Offer next steps/further reading.
- Thank user for purchase and for completing this Quick Start Guide.